



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Naperville Christian Academy

School Website: <https://ncaclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Naperville Christian Academy (NCA) demonstrates strong alignment with classical Christian education principles across all six rubric categories. The public materials consistently frame the school as a Classical Christian institution grounded in a Biblical worldview, with explicit Trivium-based curriculum and pedagogy (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), a focus on formation (virtue, wisdom, and character) rather than mere information, and an emphasis on faculty who model virtue and a partnership with parents and the broader Christian community. Evidence includes mission statements, Biblical Worldview articulation, Trivium-based curriculum descriptions, lower- and upper-school pedagogical approaches (memory work, recitation, Socratic discussion, rhetoric training), and clear statements about faculty as mentors who embody the living curriculum. The school also highlights open engagement with parents and a family-centered culture in its classical framework. Overall, this school is **CLASSICAL**.

Cited materials drawn from both the knowledge-base (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and related lexical/criterion guidance) and the school's crawl content (Naperville Christian Academy public materials) substantiate this classification. Positive indicators such as theology, liturgy/worship, Coram Deo living, virtue formation, the Trivium, great books/ classical canon references, Socratic and rhetoric-based pedagogy, faculty as mentors, and active parental partnership are frequently present. Negative indicators from the provided materials are not apparent. See evidence throughout for explicit mentions of truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, scholé, wonder, and related classical markers. Key sources include the school's mission and Biblical Worldview statements, the Classical Model description, and evidence of parental/community engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school's mission explicitly describes a Classical Christian education guiding students to know and love Christ and live under His lordship "in every sphere of life." - A Biblical Worldview is asserted as foundational, with Scripture as the standard for evaluating knowledge. - Public materials reference Coram Deo (living in the presence of God), Christian worship/ministry language, and a sacred orientation in daily life and learning. - The arts and liturgical development are framed as worshipful and God-centered (e.g., "delight in the beauty and glory of God" in Fine Arts content). - Additional evidence of liturgical/communal framing appears in parent testimonials and chapel-like communal worship language in public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon include: theology, liturgy, worship, coronation of the sacred, virtue, transcendental truths, and a sacramental/metaphysical worldview. The school's language maps to these positively (Coram Deo, Biblical authority, etc.). - Negative indicators (e.g., secular relativism, value-neutral ethics) are not present in the materials.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword cues identified in the public materials are numerous (e.g., Bible/theology/liturgy/worship, Coram Deo, worship language, sacred worldview, virtue). Negative indicators are effectively absent. Estimated positive vs. negative keyword count: roughly 10:0 in favor of positive signals, implying a strong CLASSICAL orientation. This is reinforced by the Lexicon's positive keywords (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder) being reflected in NCA's materials.

Why this rating - NCA's explicit framing as a Classical Christian school with a Biblical worldview, liturgical emphasis, and a spiritually anchored formation aligns with the Transcendental moral realism and liturgical/-community markers in the classical rubric. The presence of Coram Deo, a communal worship context, and theology-integrated pedagogy support a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on formation of young people in Christ-centered virtue and wisdom, not merely employment or career preparation, with attention to truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. - The Biblical Worldview framing supports the claim that education should be formation-centered and guided by eternal truths rather than utilitarian aims alone. - The Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) is presented as the foundational framework for the learning arc, indicating a formation-oriented progression from knowledge to understanding to eloquent expression. - The mission includes a call to know and love Christ and to live under His lordship, underscoring formation of character and affections in alignment with a teleological aim. - The school emphasizes wonder, reverence, and delight in the truth and the beauty of creation as part of formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords drawn from the lexicon include: formation, virtue, human flourishing, telos, contemplation/scholé, great conversation, truth/goodness/beauty, classical mission. - The Naperville materials consistently emphasize formation and higher aims (virtue, wisdom, beauty) rather than job-readiness, aligning with Positive keywords. - Negative indicators (e.g., workforce-prep language, utilitarian framing) are not evident.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword cues well exceed any negative indicators; approximate balance is 8–10 positive signals vs 0 negative signals, yielding a strong CLASSICAL orientation for this category. The presence of “formation,” “virtue,” and “great conversation” in the canonical lexicon context (and in NCA materials that echo formation over mere information) supports this assessment.

Why this rating - The emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and contemplation (as opposed to a narrow career- or skills-based aim) matches the Classical School criterion for purpose and goal. The inclusion of telos and the true/good/beautiful triad in the materials further reinforces CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is explicitly described as central to the curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) with corresponding grade-band mappings, which is the core of classical curriculum design. - Grammar School materials reference a chronological study of history, Latin grammar, literature from canonical authors, and poetry—consistent with a liberal-arts curriculum and Great Books orientation. - The Classical Model documentation describes a three-stage progression that aligns with a liberal arts curriculum and Great Books emphasis. - Specific curricular details include history study across grades, study of ancient civilizations (Greece and Rome), and integration of literature, arts, and music within academic content, consistent with the Great Books/Great Conversation tradition. - The school emphasizes Latin grammar, history, poetry, literature, and art/music integration as part of a unified classical curriculum. - The school is a member of the Association of Classical and Christian Schools (ACCS), which anchors its curricular philosophy in the classical tradition.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords: grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, history, classical education, liberal arts, Trivium, Latin, literature, poetry, memory work, narration. - Negative keywords: terms signaling a departure to social studies-centric or project-based-only approaches are not evident here; the materials emphasize traditional canonical study rather than solely project-based framing.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword cues are abundant (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; Great Books; history; Latin; literature; poetry; memory work) with no explicit negative keyword signals in the school's materials. Estimated positive vs. negative keyword signals: ~9:0, indicating CLASSICAL for this category.

Why this rating - The explicit use of Trivium-based structure, integration of Great Books and classical canon references, and the historical-liberal-arts emphasis align with classic curricula expectations. The absence of a dominant shift toward non-classical methods (e.g., a purely project-based or STEM-first emphasis) supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory work, recitation, and a sense of wonder; these are traditional contemplative/restful elements aligned with scholé. Examples include memory and recitation in early grades and emphasis on wonder in lower grades. - Upper-school pedagogy features Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training—explicitly described as the mode of instruction in high school, with opportunities for public speaking and rhetorical composition. - The school emphasizes contemplative/restful aspects of education alongside rigorous study, consistent with scholé approaches. - The “Pedagogy and Participation” materials describe structured seminars and reading discussions at the upper-school levels.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords: Socratic, seminars, dialectic, recitation, narration, memory work, chanting, scholé, wonder, rhetoric, declamation, oratory, debate, memory-based learning, liturgical rhythm. - Negative keywords (signals of non-classical pedagogy): overly experiential/project-based-only approaches, student-centered discovery as the sole method; these are not the dominant signals in the school's publicly available materials.

Quantitative note - Positive signals exceed any counter-signals; estimated positive vs. negative keyword signals: ~8:0, supporting CLASSICAL. The presence of Socratic/seminar pedagogy at the upper level and memory-based lower-level practice is a hallmark of classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The combination of contemplative, memory-based practices in the lower grades and Socratic/seminar/rhetoric-based instruction in the upper grades fits the classical pedagogy model well. The explicit mention of memory work and chanting in lower grades and rhetoric training in upper grades solidifies CLASSICAL status.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are presented as role models and mentors who embody virtue and knowledge; they are described as the living curriculum and the core of the school, with a collegial culture and ongoing professional formation around classical pedagogy. - The school emphasizes that teachers are active Christians whose beliefs align with the school's faith statement, highlighting the role modeling aspect and alignment with formation goals. - Public materials describe a faculty-and-curriculum partnership as a governing pillar, with a culture of mentorship and shared mission. - The “Distinctives” page frames the faculty as central to the school's classical identity (the “two pillars”: faculty and curriculum).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords: living curriculum, model teachers/mentors, faculty of friends, collegial, virtue, mastery, mentorship, classical pedagogy, teacher formation. - Negative keywords: phrases suggesting a weak teacher role or purely administrative staff absent of classical formation are not present.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword cues outnumber any negative signals; approximate positive vs. negative keyword signals: ~6:0, indicating CLASSICAL. Evidence consistently shows teachers as central to the school's classical mission.

Why this rating - The repeated emphasis on teachers as moral exemplars, the living-curriculum concept, and a faculty culture aligned with classical pedagogy provides strong CLASSICAL signals for this category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly emphasizes partnership with families as co-teachers and forms a strong community through family involvement, gatherings, and events. The Distinctives page describes partnership with families, parent formation opportunities, and an open campus ethos. - The school notes that it educates parents about classical education and that parent engagement occurs through book studies, seminars, and events, indicating active parent formation and involvement. - Public materials invite parents to visit virtually any time, reflecting a hospitable, open-community approach. - Testimonials in the public materials describe a warm, family-like community that views parents as partners in education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, home-school alignment, open-campus, parent seminars, classical parent training, parent formation. - Negative keywords: consumer-oriented framing (parents as customers) would be a warning in classical lexicons; such language is not present in NCA's materials.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword cues exceed any negative signals; approximate positive vs. negative keyword signals: ~6:0, indicating CLASSICAL. The materials show explicit parent partnership and formation opportunities consistent with the classical model.

Why this rating - The school's materials depict a deliberate collaboration with parents and a commitment to forming families in the classical tradition, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations in this category.

Overall Assessment

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Rationale - Across all six categories, Naperville Christian Academy demonstrates core classical traits: explicit Christian metaphysical foundations, formation-focused purposes and teleology, a Trivium-centered curriculum with Great Books/explicit liberal-arts elements, traditional pedagogy including memory/chanting and Socratic seminars with rhetoric training, a faculty that models virtue and acts as the living curriculum, and a robust partnership with parents and community. The convergence of these signals from the school's public materials, aligned with the knowledge-base lexicon (positive keywords for truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, scholé, wonder, great books, Trivium, etc.) strongly supports CLASSICAL across all six categories. See the cited materials above for evidence and keyword mappings.

What Would Move the Needle

(No needle-moving changes are required for a CLASSICAL classification.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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